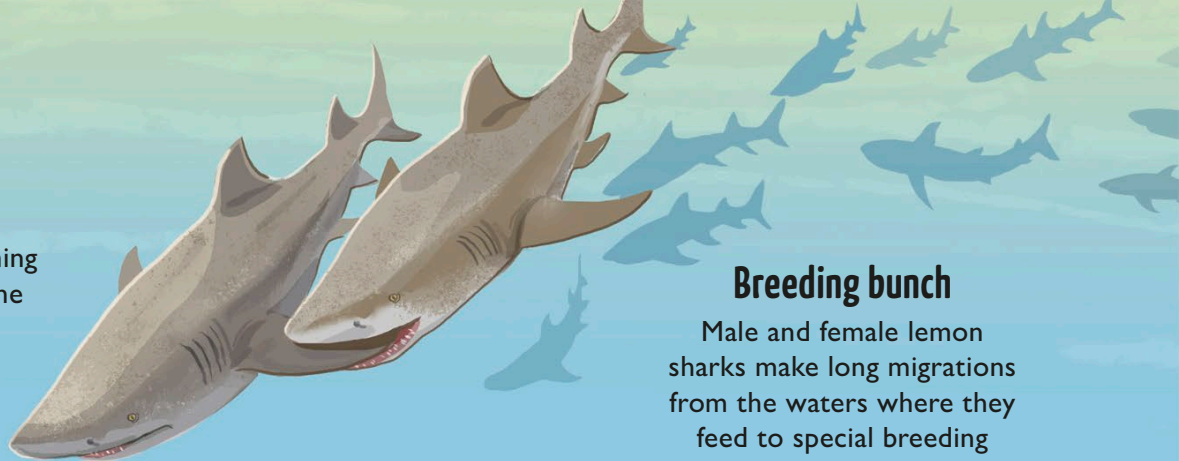


Side by side

Lemon sharks mate in shallow waters. Swimming alongside the female, the male grabs the female's pectoral fin in his jaws to keep her close to him, ready for mating.



Breeding bunch

Male and female lemon sharks make long migrations from the waters where they feed to special breeding sites. They gather together in large numbers.

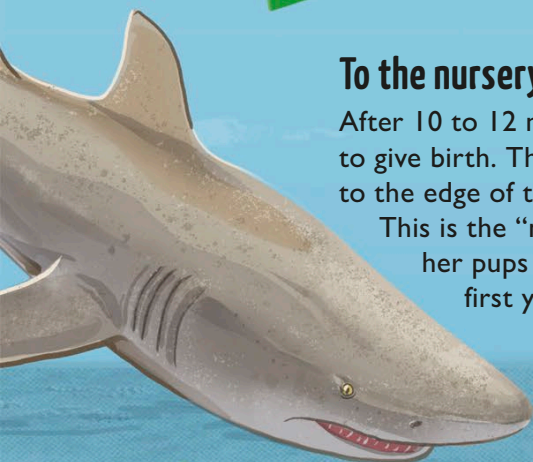
Shark

Like most sharks, the female lemon shark gives birth to her young, who can swim as soon as they're born. The baby sharks, called pups, are born near special "nursery" areas, such as coastal mangrove forests. Here, there is plenty of shelter and food to give youngsters the best chance of survival.

To the nursery

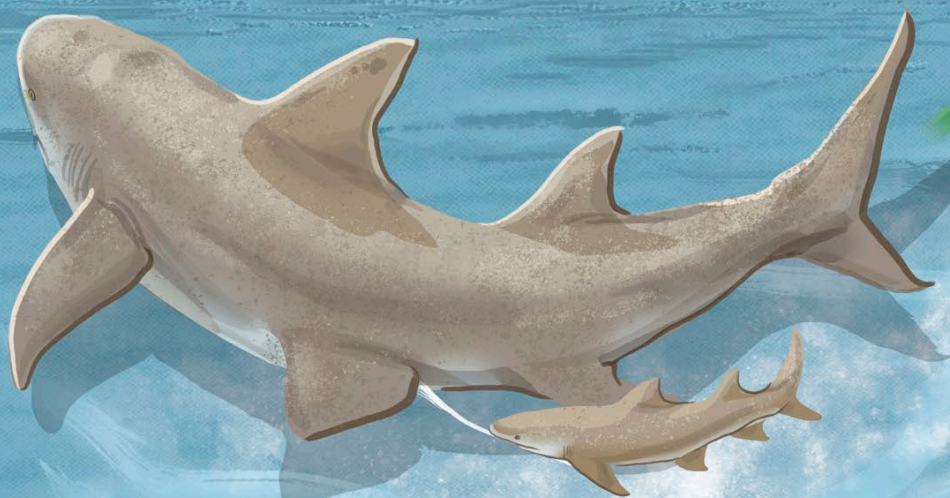
After 10 to 12 months, it is time to give birth. The female swims to the edge of the mangroves.

This is the "nursery," where her pups will spend their first years.

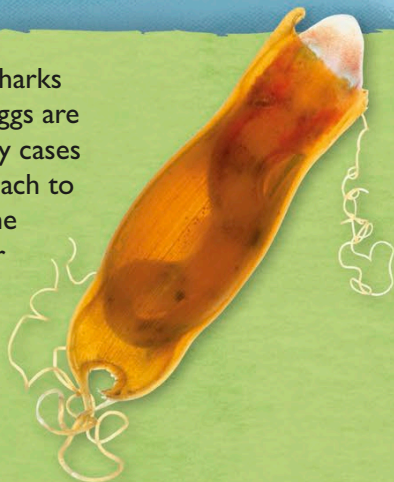


Tailfirst

The mother can have more than 10 pups per litter. The pup emerges from its mother tailfirst, still attached by its umbilical cord. As the pup swims away, the umbilical cord breaks.



Shark eggs Some sharks are egg layers. The eggs are protected by leathery cases with tendrils that attach to coral, seaweed, or the seafloor. The mother leaves the eggs to hatch on their own.



Sand tiger shark The first pup to develop inside the mother sand tiger shark eats its unborn brothers and sisters. The little cannibal then continues to feed on the eggs that are left.

